Toronto Produce Market Update - week of January 30, 2024

Source: USDA AMS Market News, Toronto terminal market (data from Infohort, Agriculture and Agri-Food Canada), converted to CAD at the Bank of Canada rate. 23 items quoted this week. Prices are wholesale per case.

Headline

- Basket moved **-1.5%** week over week (like-for-like quotes).
- **4 items need a price increase** to hold target margin; 6 have room to sharpen price or promote.
- Supply switches this week: none.

Biggest moves (week over week)

Rising	Change	Falling	Change
Zucchini	+20%	Raspberries	-12%
Yellow onions	+12%	Blueberries	-11%
Field tomatoes	+8%	Brussels sprouts	-11%
Iceberg lettuce	+6%	Cauliflower	-9%
Strawberries	+5%	Roma tomatoes	-7%

Pricing actions (list price built on the average cost of up to 4 prior weeks)

Item	Cost now (CAD/case)	Margin at current list	Target	Action	Suggested price
Zucchini	$61.43	-4%	27%	Raise price	$89.20
Yellow onions	$33.19	12%	22%	Raise price	$45.11
Field tomatoes	$50.54	19%	28%	Raise price	$74.40
Asparagus	$62.42	21%	30%	Raise price	$94.53
Roma tomatoes	$37.16	37%	28%	Lower price / promote	$54.71
Parsley (bunched)	$44.71	38%	32%	Lower price / promote	$69.70
Raspberries	$40.38	38%	32%	Lower price / promote	$62.94
Blueberries	$32.70	43%	32%	Lower price / promote	$50.97
Brussels sprouts	$34.19	45%	28%	Lower price / promote	$50.33
Strawberries	$31.21	51%	30%	Lower price / promote	$47.27

Next 4 weeks: seasonal outlook (half-strength seasonal index, 2017-2020)

- Typically **easing**: Zucchini (-16%), Field tomatoes (-15%), Roma tomatoes (-15%), Brussels sprouts (-10%).
- Typically **firming**: Bananas (+5%), Garlic (+1%), Cauliflower (+1%), Apples (tray pack) (0%).
- Seasonal outlook is a planning signal, not a weekly forecast: week to week, the latest price is the best predictor (see backtest).

Full item table

Item	CAD/case	WoW	vs 4-wk avg	Lead origin	Action
Blueberries	$32.70	-11%	-16%	Mexico	Lower price / promote
Raspberries	$40.38	-12%*	-9%	United States	Lower price / promote
Strawberries	$31.21	+5%*	-31%	Florida	Lower price / promote
Broccoli	$44.84	0%	-1%	United States	Hold
Brussels sprouts	$34.19	-11%	-24%	Mexico	Lower price / promote
Cauliflower	$37.40	-9%	-5%	United States	Hold
Apples (tray pack)	$59.45	0%	-2%	Washington	Hold
Bananas	$31.70	0%	-1%	Ecuador	Hold

Item	CAD/case	WoW	vs 4-wk avg	Lead origin	Action
Limes	$50.54	0%	+3%	Mexico	Hold
English cucumbers	$15.36	0%	-3%	Mexico	Hold
Zucchini	$61.43	+20%*	+43%	Mexico	Raise price
Parsley (bunched)	$44.71	+4%*	-8%	United States	Lower price / promote
Green leaf lettuce	$33.44	-4%*	-1%	United States	Hold
Iceberg lettuce	$43.97	+6%*	+4%	United States	Hold
Romaine lettuce	$39.63	-6%*	-3%	United States	Hold
Asparagus	$62.42	0%	+13%	Peru	Raise price
Mushrooms	$16.85	0%	-1%	Canada	Hold
Celery	$51.53	-2%	-5%	United States	Hold
Garlic	$114.94	0%	+1%	United States	Hold
Potatoes	$25.27	0%	-1%	Canada	Hold
Yellow onions	$33.19	+12%	+13%	Canada	Raise price
Field tomatoes	$50.54	+8%	+12%	Florida	Raise price
Roma tomatoes	$37.16	-7%	-13%	Mexico	Lower price / promote

* No identical quote last week (different origin or size), so the change compares this week's and last week's typical price.

Margins assume a 6% freight and handling allowance and illustrative target margins by category (config/basket.csv).